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Response for Kentucky 1861: Setup Session 3

This discussion will talk about the contradicting view of the of slavery in terms of the spirit of American freedom and liberty in “The Meaning of July Fourth for the Negro” and Stephen F. Hale, “Letter to Governor Beriah Magoffin”. To start off from the point of the north, the idea of America is having liberty and independence for all. Slavery has turned a nation who was built on protecting liberty and rights, to a nation who takes advantage of others rights for personal gain. By banning slavery the very values that make America can be restored. The meaning of July states just this patriotism for his country does not exist for his people, all Frederick Douglass sees is a country full of hypocrisy where freedom is praised, while millions are held in bondage. For the perspective of the south, slavery itself is something that they have a right to do. They believe that slaves are property and that the constitution was created to perform the functions of providing equality to all citizens, including justice, wellbeing, defense and liberty and that the government has its duty to protect citizen’s property. In addition the constitution gives the right for each state to decide on its own what and how the rights are defined and enforced. The north is in complete wrong as they cannot impose what and how the rights are enforced. They believe slavery is legal and since states have the complete say in how rights are defined and who gets those rights.